Grade 11 — Learning Evidence 2
C8, C9 and C10 — Exam Solutions

1st Term 2026–2027

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Learning objective

Apply continuous probability models and sampling distributions to investigate economic and financial questions, justify statistical methods, and communicate evidence-based conclusions.

Criteria assessment

Show all relevant calculations and clearly justify your answers. Partial credit may be awarded when the correct procedure is clearly demonstrated, even if arithmetic errors are made. No points will be awarded for answers without a demonstrated procedure, except for the brief research selection in Question 17.

A minimum of 4 points is required to pass each criterion. A 1-point penalty will be applied to each criterion if the student's name is not written on the assessment or if the assessment is submitted late.

Problems	**C8**	**C9**	**C10**
1–5: C8 direct (1 point each)	5	–	–
6–10: C8 inverse (1 point each)	5	–	–
11–13: C9 direct (2 points each)	–	6	–
14–16: C9 inverse (2 points each)	–	6	–
17: C10 research selection	–	–	6
Total: 28 points	**10**	**12**	**6**

Answer on separate paper and show your reasoning. Use only the supplied normal and Student's t reference sheets; no interpolation, CDF calculator, or inverse-CDF calculator is needed. C8 is worth **10 points**, C9 **12 points**, and C10 **6 points**: **28 points total**. At least **4 points per criterion** are required to pass that criterion. All calculations within one problem share its stated allocation, including both interval endpoints.

Evaluated criteria

C8 Uses Student's t-distribution tables, degrees of freedom, and one-tailed or two-tailed areas to determine critical values, central probabilities, and tail probabilities or probability ranges.

C9 Calculates and compares critical values and probability areas from the standard normal and Student's t-distributions, selecting and justifying the appropriate distribution according to whether the population standard deviation is known or estimated from the sample.

C10 Integrates continuous probability modelling, simulation, sampling analysis, and portfolio-risk measures to investigate an economic or financial question, justifying the selected methods and communicating results, assumptions, limitations, and evidence-based conclusions.

Models and table conventions

Problems 1–10 use the supplied signed-deviation model $X = m + aT$, $T \sim t_\nu$. Problems 11–16 compare

$$X_T = m + aT, \quad T \sim t_\nu, \qquad X_N = m + aZ, \quad Z \sim N(0,1), \qquad \nu = n - 1 .$$

Here n is the number of sample observations, m is the location (and mean for $\nu > 1$), and $a > 0$ is the scale. Use the stated *approximate standard deviation* directly as a, without adjustment. This is a teaching approximation:

$$\mathrm{SD}(X_T) = a\sqrt{\frac{\nu}{\nu - 2}} \quad (\nu > 2), \qquad \mathrm{SD}(X_N) = a.$$

The two models share a scale, not an actual variance. The approximation is coarser for small ν and improves as ν increases. Negative deviations mean below the contextual reference (early or under budget); positive deviations mean above it (late or over budget). Inverse intervals enclose modelled deviations. Standardize and back-transform using

$$c = \frac{x - m}{a}, \qquad x = m + ac .$$

The year-local sheets are in `book2026-2027/fundamentals/normal-table.tex` (and its PDF). In the t table, row ν and one-tail column α give positive t^* satisfying

$$P(T > t^*) = \alpha, \qquad P(T < -t^*) = \alpha, \qquad P(-t^* < T < t^*) = 1 - 2\alpha.$$

Obtain negative cutoffs by symmetry. The printed columns are $0.30, 0.20, 0.10, 0.05, 0.025, 0.01, 0.005$. Direct bounds recover printed three-decimal entries exactly through standardization. Report C8 probabilities as implied by these entries, and contextual cutoffs to two decimals.

The normal table gives four-decimal cumulative areas $\Phi(z) = P(Z \le z)$ for positive z. Use $\Phi(-z) = 1 - \Phi(z)$. For direct normal probabilities, round each standardized boundary to two decimals *before* lookup. For inverse normal problems, select the closest printed CDF entry. At targets 0.0500 and 0.9500, magnitudes 1.64 and 1.65 tie; choose $|z| = 1.64$, as in the C9 activity. Use the CDF table for inverse normal lookups.

For **every C9 problem**, calculate both results and

$$E_A = |r_T - r_N|, \qquad E_{Pt} = \frac{100E_A}{|r_T|}, \qquad E_{Pn} = \frac{100E_A}{|r_N|}.$$

For direct problems, r_T, r_N are probabilities; for inverse problems, they are contextual cutoffs after back-transformation. Compare inverse interval endpoints separately. A zero denominator makes that percentage undefined; the data below avoid zero denominators. These measures compare model results and do not establish error against observed truth. Report C9 probabilities and their E_A to four decimals; contextual cutoffs and their E_A to two decimals with units; and percentage comparisons to two decimals. Use unrounded back-transformed cutoffs for inverse comparisons, rounding only final results.

All results are table-based approximations, not exact distribution values: printed critical values and CDF entries are rounded. Equalities in the worked arithmetic use selected table values as working values. Both models are continuous, so endpoints have probability zero. The formally stated criteria above are retained; the supplied activity models govern the C8/C9 calculations here.

1 Courier arrival deviations [C8-1]

C8 – Direct left tail. A sample of $n = 10$ courier trips has arrival-time deviation from schedule, in minutes, with mean $m = 1$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 3$. Use $X = 1 + 3T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$.

Questions/Tasks

C8 Problem 1. Find $P(X < -4.499)$ and interpret the threshold. **[1]**

C8 – Problem 1: Direct left tail solution [1]

Here $\nu = 10 - 1 = 9$. Standardize:

$$c = \frac{-4.499 - 1}{3} = -1.833.$$

Row 9, column $\alpha = 0.05$, gives $t^* = 1.833$. By symmetry,

$$P(X < -4.499) = P(T < -1.833) \approx \boxed{0.05}.$$

About 5% of trips arrive more than 4.50 minutes early.

2 Freight cost deviations [C8-1]

C8 – Direct right tail. A sample of $n = 13$ consignments has cost deviation from budget, in dollars, with mean $m = -4$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 8$. Use $X = -4 + 8T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$.

Questions/Tasks

C8 Problem 2. Find $P(X > -10.984)$ using a complement, and explain why it exceeds 0.5. **[1]**

C8 – Problem 2: Direct right tail solution [1]

Here $\nu = 13 - 1 = 12$ and

$$c = \frac{-10.984 - (-4)}{8} = -0.873.$$

Row 12, column $\alpha = 0.20$, gives $t^* = 0.873$. Symmetry gives $P(T < -0.873) \approx 0.20$, so

$$P(X > -10.984) = 1 - P(T < -0.873) \approx 1 - 0.20 = \boxed{0.80}.$$

About 80% have costs above the threshold of approximately \$10.98 below budget. The cutoff is below $m = -4$, so the right-tail event includes more than half the symmetric model.

3 Warehouse energy deviations [C8-1]

C8 – Direct interval above the mean. Over $n = 17$ days, electricity-use deviation from forecast, in kWh, has mean $m = 2$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 6$. Use $X = 2 + 6T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$.

Questions/Tasks

C8 Problem 3. Find $P(7.19 < X < 12.476)$. **[1]**

C8 – Problem 3: Direct interval above the mean solution [1]

Here $\nu = 17 - 1 = 16$. Both bounds exceed $m = 2$:

$$c_L = \frac{7.19 - 2}{6} = 0.865, \qquad c_U = \frac{12.476 - 2}{6} = 1.746.$$

Row 16, columns $\alpha = 0.20$ and 0.05, gives 0.865 and 1.746. Subtract the nested right tails:

$$P(7.19 < X < 12.476) \approx 0.20 - 0.05 = \boxed{0.15}.$$

About 15% of days use between 7.19 and 12.48 kWh above forecast.

4 Crop shipment deviations [C8-1]

C8 – Direct interval below the mean. A sample of $n = 8$ crop shipments has mass deviation from forecast, in tonnes, with mean $m = -1$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 3$. Use $X = -1 + 3T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$.

Questions/Tasks

C8 Problem 4. Find $P(-8.095 < X < -3.688)$. **[1]**

C8 – Problem 4: Direct interval below the mean solution [1]

Here $\nu = 8 - 1 = 7$. Both bounds lie below $m = -1$:

$$c_L = \frac{-8.095 + 1}{3} = -2.365, \qquad c_U = \frac{-3.688 + 1}{3} = -0.896.$$

Row 7, columns $\alpha = 0.025$ and 0.20, gives 2.365 and 0.896. By symmetry the cumulative areas at the negative bounds are 0.025 and 0.20:

$$P(-8.095 < X < -3.688) \approx 0.20 - 0.025 = \boxed{0.175}.$$

About 17.5% of shipments fall short of forecast by between 3.69 and 8.10 tonnes.

5 Retail revenue alerts [C8-1]

C8 – Direct unequal combined tails. Over $n = 7$ weeks, revenue deviation from plan, in thousands of dollars, has mean $m = 2$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 4$. Use $X = 2 + 4T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$.

Questions/Tasks

C8 Problem 5. Find the probability of an alert: $X < -5.772$ or $X > 7.76$. [1]

C8 – Problem 5: Direct unequal combined tails solution [1]

Here $\nu = 7 - 1 = 6$ and

$$c_L = \frac{-5.772 - 2}{4} = -1.943, \qquad c_U = \frac{7.76 - 2}{4} = 1.440.$$

Row 6, columns $\alpha = 0.05$ and 0.10, gives 1.943 and 1.440. Add the disjoint tails:

$$P(X < -5.772 \text{ or } X > 7.76) \approx 0.05 + 0.10 = \boxed{0.15}.$$

About 15% of weeks trigger an alert: revenue is more than 5.77 thousand dollars below plan or 7.76 thousand dollars above it.

6 Operating cost cutoff [C8-1]

C8 – Inverse lower-tail cutoff. Over $n = 15$ production days, operating-cost deviation from budget, in dollars, has mean $m = -3$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 5$. Use $X = -3 + 5T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$.

Questions/Tasks

C8 Problem 6. Find x such that $P(X < x) = 0.10$. [1]

C8 – Problem 6: Inverse lower-tail cutoff solution [1]

Here $\nu = 15 - 1 = 14$. The lower-tail target is 0.10. Row 14, column $\alpha = 0.10$, gives $t^* = 1.345$. By symmetry $c = -1.345$; back-transform:

$$x = -3 + 5(-1.345) = -9.725 \approx \boxed{-9.73 \text{ dollars}}.$$

About 10% of days have costs more than \$9.73 below budget.

7 Loading time cutoff [C8-1]

C8 – Inverse upper-tail cutoff. A sample of $n = 21$ loading jobs has duration deviation from target, in minutes, with mean $m = 2$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 7$. Use $X = 2 + 7T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$.

Questions/Tasks

C8 Problem 7. Find x such that $P(X > x) = 0.025$. **[1]**

C8 – Problem 7: Inverse upper-tail cutoff solution [1]

Here $\nu = 21 - 1 = 20$. Row 20, column $\alpha = 0.025$, gives $c = 2.086$:

$$P(T > 2.086) \approx 0.025, \qquad x = 2 + 7(2.086) = 16.602 \approx \boxed{16.60 \text{ minutes}}.$$

About 2.5% of jobs take more than 16.60 minutes longer than target.

8 Demand deviation interval [C8-1]

C8 – Inverse central interval. Over $n = 12$ weeks, demand deviation from forecast, in tonnes, has mean $m = 4$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 9$. Use $X = 4 + 9T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$.

Questions/Tasks

C8 Problem 8. Find $L < U$ enclosing the central 90% of deviations with equal excluded tails. **[1]**

C8 – Problem 8: Inverse central interval solution [1]

Here $\nu = 12 - 1 = 11$. Each tail is $(1 - 0.90)/2 = 0.05$. Row 11, column $\alpha = 0.05$, gives $t^* = 1.796$, so $c_L = -1.796$, $c_U = 1.796$:

$$L = 4 - 9(1.796) = -12.164 \approx \boxed{-12.16 \text{ tonnes}},$$

$$U = 4 + 9(1.796) = 20.164 \approx \boxed{20.16 \text{ tonnes}}.$$

About 90% lie between 12.16 tonnes below forecast and 20.16 tonnes above it, with 5% in each excluded tail.

9 Package mass alerts [C8-1]

C8 – Inverse equal-tail alert limits. A sample of $n = 9$ packages has mass deviation from target, in grams, with mean $m = -0.4$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 1.2$. Use $X = -0.4 + 1.2T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$.

Questions/Tasks

C8 Problem 9. Find two alert limits leaving a combined outside probability of 0.05, split equally. **[1]**

C8 – Problem 9: Inverse equal-tail alert limits solution [1]

Here $\nu = 9 - 1 = 8$. Each tail has probability $0.05/2 = 0.025$. Row 8, column $\alpha = 0.025$, gives $t^* = 2.306$, so $(c_L, c_U) = (-2.306, 2.306)$:

$$L = -0.4 - 1.2(2.306) = -3.1672 \approx \boxed{-3.17 \text{ g}},$$

$$U = -0.4 + 1.2(2.306) = 2.3672 \approx \boxed{2.37 \text{ g}}.$$

About 2.5% of packages fall below L and 2.5% above U. An alert means more than 3.17 g under target or 2.37 g over target.

10 Dispatch time alerts [C8-1]

C8 – Inverse unequal-tail alert limits. A sample of $n = 16$ dispatches has departure-time deviation from schedule, in minutes, with mean $m = -2$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 6$. Use $X = -2 + 6T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$.

Questions/Tasks

C8 Problem 10. Find L, U with $P(X < L) = 0.01$ and $P(X > U) = 0.10$. **[1]**

C8 – Problem 10: Inverse unequal-tail alert limits solution [1]

Here $\nu = 16 - 1 = 15$. Use the tails separately. Row 15, column $\alpha = 0.01$, gives 2.602, so $c_L = -2.602$ by symmetry. Column $\alpha = 0.10$ gives $c_U = 1.341$:

$$L = -2 + 6(-2.602) = -17.612 \approx \boxed{-17.61 \text{ minutes}},$$

$$U = -2 + 6(1.341) = 6.046 \approx \boxed{6.05 \text{ minutes}}.$$

About 1% depart more than 17.61 minutes early, and 10% more than 6.05 minutes late. The combined alert probability is $0.01 + 0.10 = 0.11$; 0.89 lies between the limits.

11 Sales revenue shortfalls [C9-2]

C9 – Direct left tail. Over $n = 10$ weeks, sales-revenue deviation from target, in thousands of dollars, has mean $m = -2$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 5$. Compare $X_T = -2 + 5T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$, with $X_N = -2 + 5Z$.

Questions/Tasks

C9 Problem 11. Find $P(X < -11.165)$. Find both model results, calculate E_A, E_{Pt}, and E_{Pn}, and interpret the comparison. **[2]**

C9 – Problem 11: Direct left tail solution [2]

Here $\nu = 10 - 1 = 9$; $c = (-11.165 + 2)/5 = -1.833$. Row 9, column $\alpha = 0.05$, gives $t^* = 1.833$; symmetry gives

$$p_T = P(T < -1.833) \approx \boxed{0.0500}.$$

For normal, round to $z = -1.83$. Row 1.8, column 0.03, gives $\Phi(1.83) = 0.9664$:

$$p_N = 1 - 0.9664 = \boxed{0.0336}.$$

$$E_A = |0.0500 - 0.0336| = \boxed{0.0164},$$
$$E_{Pt} = \frac{100(0.0164)}{|0.0500|} \approx \boxed{32.80\%},$$
$$E_{Pn} = \frac{100(0.0164)}{|0.0336|} \approx \boxed{48.81\%}.$$

A shortfall greater than 11.17 thousand dollars has probability about 5.00% under t, compared with 3.36% under normal, a difference of 1.64 percentage points.

12 Delivery schedule deviations [C9-2]

C9 – Direct right tail. A sample of $n = 15$ deliveries has arrival-time deviation from schedule, in minutes, with mean $m = 3$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 4$. Compare $X_T = 3 + 4T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$, with $X_N = 3 + 4Z$.

Questions/Tasks

C9 Problem 12. Find $P(X > -0.472)$. Find both model results, calculate E_A, E_{Pt}, and E_{Pn}, and interpret the comparison. **[2]**

C9 – Problem 12: Direct right tail solution [2]

Here $\nu = 15 - 1 = 14$; $c = (-0.472 - 3)/4 = -0.868$. Row 14, column $\alpha = 0.20$, gives $t^* = 0.868$:

$$p_T = 1 - P(T < -0.868) \approx 1 - 0.2000 = \boxed{0.8000}.$$

For normal, round to $z = -0.87$. Row 0.8, column 0.07, gives $\Phi(0.87) = 0.8078$:

$$\Phi(-0.87) = 1 - 0.8078 = 0.1922, \qquad p_N = 1 - 0.1922 = \boxed{0.8078}.$$

$$E_A = |0.8000 - 0.8078| = \boxed{0.0078},$$
$$E_{Pt} = \frac{100(0.0078)}{|0.8000|} \approx \boxed{0.98\%},$$
$$E_{Pn} = \frac{100(0.0078)}{|0.8078|} \approx \boxed{0.97\%}.$$

The event includes arrivals less than about 0.47 minutes early and all late arrivals. Normal assigns 80.78%, which is 0.78 percentage points higher than t's 80.00%. Both exceed 0.5 because the cutoff is below $m = 3$; t does not give the larger probability for this event.

13 Fuel forecast deviations [C9-2]

C9 – Direct interval crossing the mean. Over $n = 13$ operating days, fuel-use deviation from forecast, in litres, has mean $m = 1$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 6$. Compare $X_T = 1 + 6T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$, with $X_N = 1 + 6Z$.

Questions/Tasks

C9 Problem 13. Find $P(-7.136 < X < 14.074)$. Find both model results, calculate E_A, E_{Pt}, and E_{Pn}, and interpret the comparison. **[2]**

C9 – Problem 13: Direct interval crossing the mean solution [2]

Here $\nu = 13 - 1 = 12$. Standardize:

$$c_L = \frac{-7.136 - 1}{6} = -1.356, \qquad c_U = \frac{14.074 - 1}{6} = 2.179.$$

Row 12, columns $\alpha = 0.10$ and 0.025, gives 1.356 and 2.179. The interval crosses $m = 1$ and excludes unequal tails:

$$p_T \approx 1 - 0.1000 - 0.0250 = \boxed{0.8750}.$$

For normal, round to $z_L = -1.36$ and $z_U = 2.18$. Row 1.3, column 0.06, gives $\Phi(1.36) = 0.9131$; row 2.1, column 0.08, gives $\Phi(2.18) = 0.9854$:

$$p_N = 0.9854 - (1 - 0.9131) = 0.9854 - 0.0869 = \boxed{0.8985}.$$

$$E_A = |0.8750 - 0.8985| = \boxed{0.0235},$$

$$E_{Pt} = \frac{100(0.0235)}{|0.8750|} \approx \boxed{2.69\%},$$

$$E_{Pn} = \frac{100(0.0235)}{|0.8985|} \approx \boxed{2.62\%}.$$

Fuel use lies from 7.14 litres below forecast to 14.07 litres above it with probability about 87.50% under t or 89.85% under normal. Normal assigns 2.35 percentage points more to this interval.

14 Production cost savings [C9-2]

C9 – Inverse lower-tail cutoff. A sample of $n = 8$ batches has cost deviation from budget, in dollars, with mean $m = -1$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 2.5$. Compare $X_T = -1 + 2.5T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$, with $X_N = -1 + 2.5Z$.

Questions/Tasks

C9 Problem 14. Find the cutoff x below which 5% of deviations fall. Find both model results, calculate E_A, E_{Pt}, and E_{Pn}, and interpret the comparison. **[2]**

C9 – Problem 14: Inverse lower-tail cutoff solution [2]

Here $\nu = 8 - 1 = 7$; the cumulative target is 0.0500, with $c = (x + 1)/2.5$. Row 7, column $\alpha = 0.05$, gives $t^* = 1.895$, so $c_T = -1.895$. For normal, row 1.6, columns 0.04 and 0.05, gives 0.9495 and 0.9505. The negative cumulative entries are 0.0505 and 0.0495, equally close to 0.0500. The tie rule selects $c_N = -1.64$.

$$x_T = -1 + 2.5(-1.895) = -5.7375 \approx \boxed{-5.74 \text{ dollars}},$$

$$x_N = -1 + 2.5(-1.64) = -5.10 = \boxed{-5.10 \text{ dollars}}.$$

Use unrounded contextual results:

$$E_A = |-5.7375 - (-5.10)| = 0.6375 \approx \boxed{0.64 \text{ dollars}},$$

$$E_{Pt} = \frac{100(0.6375)}{|-5.7375|} \approx \boxed{11.11\%},$$

$$E_{Pn} = \frac{100(0.6375)}{|-5.10|} = \boxed{12.50\%}.$$

About 5% of batches save more than \$5.74 under t, or \$5.10 under normal. The normal threshold is about \$0.64 closer to the mean deviation.

15 Order processing cutoff [C9-2]

C9 – Inverse upper-tail cutoff. A sample of $n = 17$ orders has processing-time deviation from target, in minutes, with mean $m = 2$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 3.5$. Compare $X_T = 2 + 3.5T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$, with $X_N = 2 + 3.5Z$.

Questions/Tasks

C9 Problem 15. Find the cutoff x exceeded by 10% of deviations. Find both model results, calculate E_A, E_{Pt}, and E_{Pn}, and interpret the comparison. **[2]**

C9 – Problem 15: Inverse upper-tail cutoff solution [2]

Here $\nu = 17 - 1 = 16$; convert right tail 0.10 to cumulative target 0.9000. With $c = (x - 2)/3.5$, row 16, column $\alpha = 0.10$, gives $c_T = 1.337$. For normal, row 1.2, column 0.08, gives $\Phi(1.28) = 0.8997$, closer to 0.9000 than $\Phi(1.29) = 0.9015$ (column 0.09). Thus $c_N = 1.28$.

$$x_T = 2 + 3.5(1.337) = 6.6795 \approx \boxed{6.68 \text{ minutes}},$$
$$x_N = 2 + 3.5(1.28) = 6.48 = \boxed{6.48 \text{ minutes}}.$$

Use unrounded cutoffs:

$$E_A = |6.6795 - 6.48| = 0.1995 \approx \boxed{0.20 \text{ minutes}},$$
$$E_{Pt} = \frac{100(0.1995)}{|6.6795|} \approx \boxed{2.99\%},$$
$$E_{Pn} = \frac{100(0.1995)}{|6.48|} \approx \boxed{3.08\%}.$$

About 10% of orders take more than 6.68 minutes above target under t, or 6.48 minutes under normal. The normal cutoff is about 0.20 minutes lower.

16 Cargo mass deviation interval [C9-2]

C9 – Inverse central interval. A sample of $n = 10$ cargo loads has mass deviation from target, in kg, with mean $m = 1.5$ and approximate standard deviation $a = 4$. Compare $X_T = 1.5 + 4T$, $T \sim t_{n-1}$, with $X_N = 1.5 + 4Z$.

Questions/Tasks

C9 Problem 16. Find the central 95% interval with equal excluded tails under each model. Calculate E_A, E_{Pt}, and E_{Pn} separately for each endpoint, and interpret. **[2]**

C9 – Problem 16: Inverse central interval solution **[2]**

Here $\nu = 10 - 1 = 9$. Each tail is $(1 - 0.95)/2 = 0.025$, so cumulative targets are 0.0250 and 0.9750. Standardize unknown limits with $c_L = (L - 1.5)/4$ and $c_U = (U - 1.5)/4$. Row 9, column $\alpha = 0.025$, gives $t^* = 2.262$, hence $(c_{T,L}, c_{T,U}) = (-2.262, 2.262)$. For normal, row 1.9, column 0.06, gives $\Phi(1.96) = 0.9750$ exactly at printed precision; symmetry gives $\Phi(-1.96) = 0.0250$. Thus $(c_{N,L}, c_{N,U}) = (-1.96, 1.96)$.

Back-transform, retaining unrounded values:

$$L_T = 1.5 - 4(2.262) = -7.548 \approx \boxed{-7.55 \text{ kg}},$$
$$U_T = 1.5 + 4(2.262) = 10.548 \approx \boxed{10.55 \text{ kg}},$$
$$L_N = 1.5 - 4(1.96) = -6.34 = \boxed{-6.34 \text{ kg}},$$
$$U_N = 1.5 + 4(1.96) = 9.34 = \boxed{9.34 \text{ kg}}.$$

Lower endpoint comparison:

$$E_{A,L} = |-7.548 - (-6.34)| = 1.208 \approx \boxed{1.21 \text{ kg}},$$
$$E_{Pt,L} = \frac{100(1.208)}{|-7.548|} \approx \boxed{16.00\%},$$
$$E_{Pn,L} = \frac{100(1.208)}{|-6.34|} \approx \boxed{19.05\%}.$$

Upper endpoint comparison:

$$E_{A,U} = |10.548 - 9.34| = 1.208 \approx \boxed{1.21 \text{ kg}},$$
$$E_{Pt,U} = \frac{100(1.208)}{|10.548|} \approx \boxed{11.45\%},$$
$$E_{Pn,U} = \frac{100(1.208)}{|9.34|} \approx \boxed{12.93\%}.$$

The central intervals are approximately $(-7.55, 10.55)$ kg under t and $(-6.34, 9.34)$ kg under normal, with 2.5% in each excluded tail. Negative limits mean below target mass; positive limits mean above it. The normal interval extends about 1.21 kg less far from m at each end. Percentage comparisons differ because the endpoint magnitudes differ.



17 Choose your research option [C10-6]

During the exam: select **1** of the following options and write a very brief description (1–2 sentences) of real-life data that could plausibly follow your selected distribution. **[6]**

(a) A continuous variable modelled by a linear probability density over a stated range.
(b) Waiting times or intervals between events modelled by an exponential distribution.
(c) Normally distributed measurements.

No datasets, sources, calculations, parameter estimates, or detailed model justification are required during the exam.

Online report submission: your PDF report will focus on the **1** selected option and must be submitted virtually through **Open**. This online submission is separate from the brief response written during the exam. To demonstrate the full C10 criterion, investigate an economic or financial question using real data and your selected continuous model. Include simulation, sampling analysis, and portfolio-risk measures; justify the selected methods and communicate results, assumptions, limitations, and evidence-based conclusions. The 6 points shown here assess the brief exam response; the report provides the broader C10 evidence.

Questions/Tasks

C10 Select only one option and give a brief description (1–2 sentences) of plausible real-life data. **[6]**

C10 – Acceptable alternative brief responses [6]

This selection task has no unique answer. A student submits **only one** 1–2 sentence response, choosing one option. The following are **alternatives**, not three required submissions:

(a) Linear density. I would study customers' spending in thousands of Colombian pesos on a promotional service priced continuously between 20 and 60 thousand pesos, proposing a linearly decreasing density over $[20, 60]$. I would check whether real observations support that proposed model.

(b) Exponential waiting times. I would study the minutes between payment requests reaching a small business during a stable trading period, proposing an exponential waiting-time model if arrivals are independent and occur at a constant average rate. I would check that assumption with real observations.

(c) Normal measurements. I would study the fill volumes in millilitres of bottles sold by a beverage producer, proposing a normal model during stable production. I would check whether real measurements support that model.

Each describes possible real-life economic data and a *proposed* model requiring validation; none claims that uncollected data follow the model. Other plausible responses are acceptable. The brief exam response requires no dataset, sources, calculations, parameter estimates, or detailed model justification. The original six points apply to this brief selection; no additional point allocation is imposed here.

Separate online PDF report (not the brief exam response). Submit through **Open**, focusing on the **one selected option**. Investigate an economic or financial question using real data and the selected continuous model. Include simulation, sampling analysis, and portfolio-risk measures; justify methods and present results, assumptions, limitations, and evidence-based conclusions. These are the broader C10 requirements; no completed report, dataset, simulation, portfolio analysis, or empirical conclusion is supplied by these examples.